

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

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VIRAT KOHLI, 34

CRICKETER

Bat Man Forever

BECAUSE despite relinquishing the captaincy of the Indian team (in all formats), Kohli still remains the most celebrated cricketer of his generation. His massive social media following also makes him one of the top global influencers, placing him in the list of richest sportspersons

BECAUSE Kohli, who has the second highest number of centuries (75) in world cricket, is back to his usual game-changer level form after 1,021 days without a hundred. He broke the drought with a Twenty20 century against Afghanistan in the Asia Cup in September 2022 and hasn't looked back since. There were four more hundreds in Tests and ODIs and he was on fire in the 2023 IPL edition

COACH ON CALL **Still gets shame-faced when childhood coach Rajkumar Sharma calls and points out flaws in his batting**

BECAUSE he makes news on and off the field, voicing opinions on social causes or scrapping with fellow players or seniors. He has openly talked about the mental pressures of the game, while his public spat with ex-cricketer-turned-MP Gautam Gambhir was one of the talking points of this year's IPL

BECAUSE he and actress wife Anushka Sharma remain one of India's most celebrated power couples

